

WELCOME TO THE DISCWORLD

A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world

TONE: dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

THE DISC

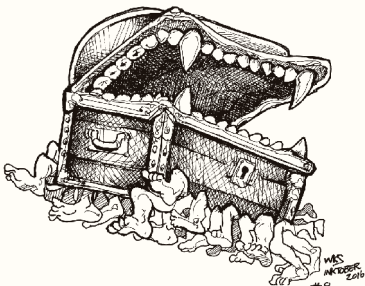
A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
 - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
 - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
 - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
 - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
 - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.



Drawn by Naiche Washburn

YOU ARE SOMETHING ODD

- **Tip:** you'll need to work a bit harder at this one, so if you're newer to roleplaying or don't know Discworld very well, consider switching to something else.
- **What you are:** something that really shouldn't be able to think, but does. A cow, a candlestick, a sword, a swarm of bees, a book of fairytales... Enough magic leaked into you to wake up. You can form your own opinion on how you feel about that.
- **Examples from the books:** **The Luggage** (a sapient pearwood travelling trunk on hundreds of little legs, bad-tempered, treats walls as optional), **Gaspode** (a mangy talking dog), **Maurice** (a clever cat who ate a mouse that ate magical rubbish), **the Librarian** (a wizard turned orangutan), and wizards' staffs and hats that gain opinions.
- **Stereotypes:** *takes being whatever it is very seriously.* A candlestick is vain about being tall and afraid of draughts, a cat wants people to think it is just a cat, and a swarm of bees is a committee.
- **Names:** your old name (Gaspode) or your job (the Luggage, the Librarian).